In an emergency, call 911 first!

Operations Leadership (Staff)

- Heather Gale (267) 542-9827
- Kimberly Renner (267) 995-1283
- Lisa McGee (201) 452-2703

Operations Leadership (Volunteer)

- Debbie Tevlin (484) 680-2888
- Marty Westermann (610) 850-2192
- Hal Cohen (302) 369-6901
- Ed Robold (267) 315-2767

Disaster Health Services (DHS)

- Kate Byrnes (610) 762-8202
- Eileen Rall (215) 280-7379

Disaster Mental Health (DMH)

- Randy Miller (856) 745-4573

Disaster Spiritual Care (DSC)

- Charline Scott (215) 435-9699

Disability Integration (DDI)

- Linda Scheuermann (412) 400-8096

Logistics/Warehouse (Supplies)

- Chris Robold (215) 622-8613
- Fred Lehman (215) 313-3552
- Larry Daly (215) 391-8909

Staffing

- Mary Hughes (267) 808-1626
- Janice Thomas. (610) 730-0639

SCIA Problems

- Sean Snyder (267) 432-3792

RC Care Issues

- Maureen Streeter (267) 542-1517
- Donna Zacker (307) 871-6654

Media

- Alana Mauger (267) 683-5488

Government Operations

- Janice Winston (215) 806-0300

Feeding

- Joe Hughes (310) 619-4946
- Diane Heard (610) 416-5238

Pet Liaison

- Rahel Pachter (484) 557-8308

Who to call?

1. For emergency matters, call 911! Then call one of the people listed under volunteer and one under staff leadership. **Work through the numbers until you reach someone no matter what time it is**.

2. For important but non-emergency matters, call the overall Shelter Manager. This will likely be one of the four people listed under 'Volunteer Leadership' above. The outgoing SV should tell you who that is. If you cannot reach that person, work through the other three listed under volunteer leadership.
3. If you need something specific – food, supplies, extra staff or missing staff – call the relevant department number above. If you are unable to reach them, try the shelter manager and then work through the volunteer leadership listed above.

Checklist for beginning a shift

1. Meet with the outgoing supervisor and educate yourself on the status of the shelter
2. Walk the whole facility including the restrooms and outside areas
    a. There may be a facilities checklist to complete. Consult outgoing SV or shelter manager. Phone numbers listed on Page One.
3. Review the shelter log
4. Locate both Red Cross and host facility medical equipment
5. Locate the wifi password and phone number for the facilities maintenance person
6. Make yourself aware of who the current RC staff back up is and who the volunteer Shelter Manager is.
7. Take a rough head count of the clients in the shelter and compare that with the numbers in SCIA. Try to reconcile any mismatches using the sign in/out sheets. If on the night shift, see below for further steps.
8. Assess any food or materials that will be needed and communicate that with the logistics team. See below for information on how this is done and what information is needed.
9. Conduct a Job Induction for your incoming staff

Job Inductions

The purpose of a job induction is for the SV to assess the skills and experience of their staff and provide guidance, training and expectations to them for their assignments during this shift. Areas to cover include:

1. A review of GAPs and prior experience
2. Inquire if staff have any interests or preferences for what they would like to do. Meet those requests if possible.
3. Make staff aware of any known issues in the shelter and remind them that we <u>do not share</u> any information (when they will be returning, issues with the property, information about other clients, etc.) with clients outside of designated client meetings since events often change and information shared can be perceived as a promise by clients.
4. Walk staff through the facility. Highlight the locations of emergency exits, corridors that must be kept clear for safety and where to find medical equipment.
5. Assign staff to specific responsibilities (feeding, registration, etc.) and provide any training they may need to complete those tasks.

General Tips

1. Circulate throughout the shift to answer questions and concerns that may have come up since the initial induction was done.
2. Solicit feedback on difficulties they may be encountering and any suggestions they might have for improving the system.
3. Try to move people between tasks if possible so they can try multiple areas during their shift.
4. Remember to explain *Why* something is done as well as how it is done.

Tasks

Feeding – Day Shift

There is a great deal of information required by our feeding teams each day to ensure there is enough food for upcoming meals and that specific dietary needs are being met. This is important to avoid food waste, establish ongoing budgetary needs, and coordinate with partner organizations who may be providing food to our shelter. Some of the information to be collected is:

1. How many meals were served?
    a. This can be difficult to ascertain in a busy shelter. You can ask your feeding team to keep a loose count as they go, but other useful techniques include:
        i. Count how many trays of a specific food are left over at the end of a meal and communicate that to the feeding team. They can often work backward from that to the amounts needed.
            1. *"We used three of the four trays of rice. All of the salad, All of the chicken, and half a tray of the mac and cheese."*
2. Ascertain if any specific client dietary needs were not met.
3. Ascertain if we are low on snacks, coffee, creamer/milk, or any of the in between meal or early morning needs.
4. Communicate this to the feeding lead and/or the shelter manager. Phone numbers on Page One.

Supplies – Day Shift

Supplies include nonperishable goods such as cots, blankets, diapers, clothing, water and anything else that would be stored in our warehouse. The logistics team will deliver these once a day. They are requested via a form called the 6409. If you are not sure how to do this, call your shelter manager.

Head Count – Night Shift

By 10 pm, the number of actual clients in the building must be reconciled with the number of people who *should* be in the building according to SCIA. Very often these two numbers will not match, so it is advised that a preliminary head count be done beginning at 8pm. The sign out sheet can then be checked to see if any of the missing clients appear there. If a client is not present and does not appear as signed out, call them using the contact info available in SCIA to see if they plan to return. If the disparity between numbers is significant call the preceding shelter supervisor for any information they may have and notify the shelter manager or staff back up. **This information is key to the safety of our clients and the forward planning of our staff and volunteer leadership**. **It is best practice to have more than one volunteer do a count to ensure the counts match.**

Reporting – All shifts

All of the above information should be entered into SCIA and conveyed verbally to the relevant leadership member listed on Page One. If you have problems using SCIA, contacts are listed on Page One as well.

Scenarios – What to do if/when …

There is a major health issue or violence …

1. If DHS or DMH/DSC is on scene, defer to their training and support their instructions
    a. In the case of a threat of violence go directly to **911**
2. If DHS or DMH/DSC is not on scene, call **911**
3. After calling 911, inform
    a. Regional Leadership (see contact numbers on page one)
    b. DHS/DMH/DSC leads
    c. Record the event in the shelter log and verbally inform your replacement supervisor when the shift changes
    d. Gather any relevant information about other members with the affected individual to share with the above departments
4. Check in with your staff and remaining residents to make sure everyone else is ok and is processing the event in a healthy manner. If anyone, volunteer or client, seems overwhelmed, notify our teams so they can follow up with them as soon as possible.

A Note on Narcan

We have Narcan in the medical kit included in our shelters. Narcan reverses the effect of a drug overdose. It is a nasal spray like any you might use at home. You put it in the individual's nose and squeeze the dispenser.

*Use it if someone is unresponsive and cannot be woken up. It **cannot** hurt someone or make it worse. Be aware that it will work very quickly and the person may be disoriented or aggressive when they wake up. 911 should already be on the way as they will still need further care.*

Media or a politician arrive …

1. Greet them warmly and thank them for their concern
2. Explain that the Red Cross dormitories are for displaced people only and as, for the time they are with us, this is their home, non-Red Cross personnel may not go inside.
    a. EXCEPTION: Local politicians may go in, but no cameras are allowed.
3. Tell MEDIA we will let shelter residents know that they are here and they may choose to come out to speak with if they choose to, **but MEDIA can never go into the shelter**.
4. Finally, explain that you will put them in touch with our public relations office straight away.
    a. Call Alayna Mauger whose number is listed on Page 1.
    b. Call your Shelter Manager and inform them of the arrival.
5. When speaking with the media …
    a. Do **not** discuss conditions or people inside the shelter in any way.
    b. Do **not** go into the needs or challenges we might be facing. Media relations team will handle that if appropriate.
    c. **Do** say that ***everyone*** affected by this event is welcome to come if they are in need.

All you should publicly say is the below

"The Red Cross is doing all it can to alleviate human suffering caused by this event and we are thankful for the help and support of the community and our partner organizations. Out of respect for the privacy of our residents I cannot provide any more information here, but I am happy to direct you to our public relations team."

Rumors begin going around …

1. **Never** confirm or deny any rumors people bring to you. This is an emergency situation and as such it is always in flux. What you may have heard from another RC volunteer or agency may change at any moment. We really don't know when the shelter is closing or what the landlord is doing until it is approved for dissemination by leadership.
2. Some common rumors are
    i. The shelter is closing
    ii. The landlord is doing xxx (good or bad)
    iii. X person in the shelter did Y thing/ X person was thrown out/X person told me …
3. To counter this, simply reassure them that if there are any changes or updates coming, there will be a general meeting held to inform all residents. They will have advanced notice of any significant changes.
4. Be mindful of your own staff, usually with the best of intentions, confirming rumors. Things like, "I heard you'll be going home tomorrow" can be devastating to walk back if things should change overnight. It is common for plans and information to change at the last moment, so be mindful that it is hard to put the toothpaste back in the tube if a promise is made.

Red Cross Personnel do not show up for their shift

1. If they are more than fifteen minutes late, call them.
2. If you cannot reach them, notify staff services of the problem and they will reach out to find them.
    a. When people are on a shelter shift it is the same as on a DAT call. We are responsible for their safety and must locate them
3. Notify your shelter manager that you are short staffed and begin to plan for how to hold the fort for up to an hour until a replacement can arrive.
    a. If you cannot reach your shelter manager, call your staff back up or anyone listed under "Regional Leadership" on Page 1.